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Guidance (grey): delete before sending. Print on your institution's letterhead, keep it to one page, and address the editor by name. The letter sells the paper: why it matters and why it fits THIS journal.

[DD Month YYYY]

Dr [Editor's full name]

[Editor-in-Chief], [Journal name]

[Journal postal or online address]

Dear Dr [Editor's surname],

Re: Submission of the manuscript "[Full title]"

Please consider our manuscript for publication as an [Original Research article] in [Journal name].

Paragraph 2: the question and why it matters (2–3 sentences).

[e.g. Fluid accumulation is common in septic shock, but whether restricting fluids improves survival is unknown.]

Paragraph 3: what you did and the main finding, with the key number, calibrated to the design.

[e.g. In this pilot randomised trial of 60 adults, a restrictive strategy was feasible, and 28-day mortality was ... (risk ratio ..., 95% CI ...).]

Paragraph 4: why this journal: its scope, readers, or recent papers on the topic.

[e.g. The findings are directly relevant to your readers in critical care and extend your recent work on fluid stewardship.]

We confirm that this manuscript is original, has not been published and is not under consideration elsewhere [a preprint is available at ...]. All authors have approved the manuscript and agree with its submission. The study was approved by [Ethics committee name] (no. [number]) and registered at [registry, number]. It is reported according to [CONSORT / STROBE / ...]; the completed checklist is attached. The authors declare [no competing interests].

Optional: suggested reviewers (name, institution, email, expertise; no collaborators from the last 3 years) and reviewers to exclude, with a reason.

Thank you for considering our work. We look forward to hearing from you.

Yours sincerely,

[Name, qualifications]

[Corresponding author, on behalf of all authors]

[Department, Institution · email · phone · ORCID]